

Drake Thorne

Network Platform Engineer | Haymarket, NSW

contact@drakethorne.com | drakethorne.com | linkedin.com/in/drakethorne

SUMMARY

Network Platform Engineer with 4+ years of experience designing, automating, and operating network and infrastructure environments across on-premises and cloud platforms. Well versed in building scalable solutions using Ansible, Terraform, Python, Git, and NetBox. Experienced building and operating automation platforms on Linux using Docker, Kubernetes (Amazon EKS), Infrastructure as Code, and Git-based CI/CD pipelines.

EXPERIENCE

Nine Entertainment

Network Platform Engineer

North Sydney, NSW

Aug 2024 – Present

- Developed and delivered network automation frameworks for multiple full-site EVPN-VXLAN spine-leaf fabrics across Juniper QFX/EX and Fortinet platforms, leveraging Juniper Mist, Terraform, Ansible, Python, and GitHub Actions. Automated BGP policies, peering, ESI-LAG, IRB/VRF management, and port allocation.
- Developed and maintained Ansible automation frameworks and API-driven workflows integrating NetBox, Infoblox, LogicMonitor, ServiceNow, Cisco ISE, and Cisco Catalyst Center, enabling scalable infrastructure management across 1,500+ network devices while significantly reducing manual toil.
- Engineered repeatable microservices deployments on Amazon EKS via Helm charts and Kubernetes manifests. Included NetBox (source of truth for 1500+ devices), Oxidized, AWX, and self-hosted Docker Registry with pull-through cache.
- Developed event-driven, serverless AWS pipelines connecting Basware and Microsoft D365, using AWS Lambdas written in Golang. Managed infrastructure such as EventBridge, SQS, API Gateway, S3, and IAM roles via Terraform.
- Built and maintained Docker images for development containers and production execution environments using Ansible Builder and Git-based CI/CD workflows via GitHub Actions, publishing multi-architecture ARM64/AMD64 images to Amazon ECR.
- Led the end-to-end migration of enterprise DHCP infrastructure from Windows DHCP Server to Infoblox across all sites, developing Ansible automation for IPAM migration, DHCP scope provisioning, and VXLAN gateway updates. Provided post-migration operational support.
- Automated Amazon RDS lifecycle management processes using Ansible, reducing manual database provisioning and maintenance effort by approximately 50%.
- Automated credential lifecycle management across hundreds of Cisco IOS and NX-OS devices using Ansible and 1Password.
- Designed and deployed automated ERSPAN unicast monitoring workflows integrated with ExtraHop, increasing network traffic visibility to approximately 80% of RX traffic.
- Monitored and remediated containerised workloads on Amazon Elastic Kubernetes Service, diagnosing and resolving pod failures, performance bottlenecks, and cluster resource constraints.

Fin Design + Effects

Systems Administrator

Surry Hills, NSW

Apr 2023 – Aug 2024

- Designed and delivered a centralized monitoring and telemetry platform across 500+ nodes using Graylog, Zabbix, Grafana, and Slack integrations, significantly improving observability and reducing incident response times.
- Developed Ansible-based automation for Linux fleet management across 50+ servers, including configuration management, scheduled task orchestration, patching, and operational maintenance.
- Built and implemented secure remote access infrastructure using Duo MFA, RADIUS authentication, L2TP/IPsec VPNs, Active Directory integration, Apache, and Nginx reverse proxy technologies.

- Managed hybrid infrastructure environments spanning Windows Server, VMware, TrueNAS, Google Cloud Platform, and Linux systems, supporting business-critical production workloads.
- Designed, deployed, and maintained Layer 2 and Layer 3 network infrastructure across Brocade and Cisco platforms, including VLANs, VRFs, LAG/LACP, NAT, and routing services.
- Implemented network security controls through ACL management, Barracuda firewall administration, and PowerShell-based encryption automation to strengthen infrastructure security posture.

EDUCATION

Macquarie University

Diploma of Information Technology, Computer Science

WAM: 81.875

Macquarie Association of Computing Students (MACS) | Academic Integrity Certification

North Ryde, NSW

Graduated 2022

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, Bash, PowerShell, REST APIs

Automation & IaC: Ansible, AWX, Terraform, Git, GitHub Actions

Containers & Platforms: Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, Linux

Cloud: AWS (EKS, EC2, ECR, EDS, S3)

Networking: NetBox, Cisco IOS/NX-OS, Juniper, Mist, FortiGate, Brocade

Monitoring & Operations: LogicMonitor, Infoblox, Wireshark, Nginx, Apache